KidsPortal

English Curriculum & Syllabus Guide

Grades 1 – 10 · A reference for parents

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About this guide

This document lists every topic your child covers in KidsPortal's English subject, grade by grade, so you can see exactly what is being taught and when. Each grade also includes a note on how that stage aligns with England's National Curriculum for English — the primary framework this subject is built on — with the roughly equivalent US grade band noted alongside for families comparing against Common Core ELA standards.

These alignment notes describe the learning stage and skill focus each framework shares with that grade — not a word-for-word copy of either curriculum's official programme of study, since specific texts and exam boards vary by school.

Grade 1

Phonics and early reading fluency, alongside the building blocks of a sentence — nouns, verbs, adjectives and basic punctuation.

1	Phonics & Spelling Patterns
2	Reading for Pleasure & Fluency
3	Sentence Types
4	Nouns, Verbs & Adjectives
5	Joining Ideas
6	Punctuation Basics
7	Narrative Writing
8	Instructions & Information Texts
9	Poetry & Performance
10	Review: Sentence & Word Building
11	Rhyming Words & Word Families
12	Describing Words (Adjectives in Action)
13	Story Sequencing: Beginning, Middle & End
14	Question Words & Asking Questions
15	Capital Letters & Full Stops Review
16	Retelling a Story in Order
17	Rhyming Words
18	Alphabetical Order
19	Describing People and Places
20	Types of Sentences
21	Retelling a Favourite Story
22	Opposite Words (Antonyms)

HOW THIS ALIGNS WITH REAL-WORLD CURRICULA

Matches the Key Stage 1 (Year 1) National Curriculum for English — phonics, word reading and simple sentence writing — broadly equivalent to US Kindergarten early literacy expectations.

Grade 2

Reading between the lines, organising ideas into paragraphs, and widening vocabulary with prefixes, suffixes and compound words.

1	Reading Comprehension: Inference
2	Prefixes & Word Families
3	Paragraphs & Text Organisation
4	Conjunctions & Adverbs
5	Direct Speech & Punctuation
6	Descriptive Writing
7	Non-Chronological Reports
8	Apostrophes for Possession
9	Poetry: Figurative Language
10	Homophones & Word Roots
11	Prefixes & Suffixes
12	Compound Words
13	Writing Simple Poems
14	Synonyms & Antonyms
15	Using Commas in Lists
16	Writing a Simple Recount
17	Prefixes (un-, re-, dis-)
18	Writing Instructions
19	Reading and Writing Simple Poems
20	Suffixes (-ful, -less, -ly)
21	Writing a Simple Letter
22	Describing a Story Character

HOW THIS ALIGNS WITH REAL-WORLD CURRICULA

Matches the Key Stage 1 (Year 2) National Curriculum for English, where pupils move from single sentences to short, organised paragraphs — broadly equivalent to US Grade 1 English Language Arts standards.

Grade 3

Skimming and scanning for information, expanding sentences with noun phrases and fronted adverbials, and first steps in persuasive writing.

1	Skimming & Scanning
2	Expanded Noun Phrases
3	Fronted Adverbials
4	Paragraphing for Cohesion
5	Standard English
6	Persuasive Writing
7	Explanation Texts
8	Possessive Pronouns & Apostrophes
9	Narrative Verse
10	Statutory Spelling: Years 3–4
11	Similes & Metaphors
12	Paragraph Structure
13	Persuasive Writing Basics
14	Expanded Noun Phrases
15	Direct Speech & Punctuation
16	Non-Chronological Reports
17	Organising Writing into Paragraphs
18	Persuasive Writing Basics
19	Myths and Legends
20	Simple and Compound Sentences
21	Diary Writing
22	Information and Non-fiction Texts

HOW THIS ALIGNS WITH REAL-WORLD CURRICULA

Matches the Key Stage 2 (Year 3) National Curriculum for English, including the statutory Years 3–4 spelling list — broadly equivalent to US Grade 2 Common Core ELA standards for that band.

Grade 4

Comparing texts and themes, using relative clauses and modal verbs, and writing with tension, discussion and figurative language.

1	Comparing Texts & Themes
2	Relative Clauses
3	Modal Verbs
4	Cohesion Devices
5	Parenthesis
6	Discussion Texts
7	Narrative Writing: Tension
8	Formal & Informal Writing
9	Classic & Narrative Poems
10	Word Origins & Etymology
11	Figurative Language
12	Formal vs Informal Writing
13	Editing & Proofreading
14	Apostrophes: Possession & Contraction
15	Conjunctions: Extending Sentences
16	Diary Writing
17	Similes and Metaphors
18	Writing a Playscript
19	Standard English vs. Informal Language
20	Past, Present and Future Tense Review
21	Writing a Balanced Argument
22	Shape Poems and Haiku

HOW THIS ALIGNS WITH REAL-WORLD CURRICULA

Matches the Key Stage 2 (Year 4) National Curriculum for English, with growing sentence complexity and a wider range of text types — broadly equivalent to US Grade 3 Common Core ELA standards.

Grade 5

Critical analysis and summarising, active and passive voice, cohesive extended writing, and oracy through debate.

1	Summarising & Critical Analysis
2	Active & Passive Voice
3	The Subjunctive & Formal Structures
4	Cohesion Across a Text
5	Colons, Semicolons & Hyphens
6	Extended Narrative Writing
7	Journalistic Writing
8	SPaG Review
9	Analysing Imagery & Form
10	Oracy & Debate
11	Debate & Argument Writing
12	Analysing Character & Setting
13	Newspaper Report Writing
14	Fronted Adverbials
15	Relative Clauses
16	Balanced Argument Writing
17	Modal Verbs
18	First vs Third Person Narration
19	Writing a Biography
20	Cohesive Devices (Linking Ideas)
21	Using Flashback in Narrative
22	Writing a Newspaper Report

HOW THIS ALIGNS WITH REAL-WORLD CURRICULA

Matches the Key Stage 2 (Year 5) National Curriculum for English, where pupils are expected to sustain longer, more cohesive writing — broadly equivalent to US Grade 4 Common Core ELA standards.

Grade 6

An introduction to literary analysis and Shakespeare, narrative structure, rhetoric, and writing in a distinct voice.

1	Introduction to Literary Analysis
2	Shakespeare: An Introduction
3	Narrative Structures
4	Sentence Variety for Effect
5	Creative Writing: Voice & Viewpoint
6	Rhetoric & Persuasive Techniques
7	Poetry: Form & Structure
8	Media & Digital Texts
9	Presentations & Debate
10	Introduction to Pre-1914 Literature
11	Poetic Devices & Analysis
12	Extended Narrative Writing
13	Comparing Texts
14	Active & Passive Voice
15	Semi-Colons, Colons & Dashes
16	Writing a Personal Essay
17	Rhetorical Devices
18	Historical and Social Context in Texts
19	Travel Writing
20	Formal vs Informal Register
21	Irony and Sarcasm
22	Writing a Book Review

HOW THIS ALIGNS WITH REAL-WORLD CURRICULA

Matches the Key Stage 2 (Year 6) National Curriculum for English, the final year of primary writing composition and grammar before secondary school — broadly equivalent to US Grade 5 Common Core ELA standards.

Grade 7

Studying a full novel and a Shakespeare play, comparing viewpoints across texts, and building argumentative essay skills.

1	Studying a Novel
2	Shakespeare: A Full Play
3	Conflict Poetry
4	Complex Sentences & Clauses
5	Genre Conventions
6	Comparing Viewpoints
7	Gothic & Genre Fiction
8	Media Literacy & Bias
9	Argumentative Essay Writing
10	Introduction to World Literature
11	Persuasive Speech Writing
12	Analysing Non-Fiction Texts
13	Introduction to Shakespeare
14	Analysing Dialogue in Fiction
15	Tone & Register
16	Writing a Film/Book Review
17	Narrative Structure (Exposition to Resolution)
18	Character Development Analysis
19	Writing a Persuasive Speech
20	Symbolism in Literature
21	Preparing for a Debate
22	Writing an Autobiographical Piece

HOW THIS ALIGNS WITH REAL-WORLD CURRICULA

Matches the Key Stage 3 (Year 7) National Curriculum for English, where secondary pupils first study a complete novel and a Shakespeare play in full — broadly equivalent to US Grade 6 Common Core ELA standards.

Grade 8

Unseen poetry, 19th-century prose, analysing rhetoric, and transactional writing — early GCSE-style exam skills.

1	Unseen Poetry
2	Shakespeare: Essay Writing
3	19th-Century Prose
4	Modern Prose or Drama
5	Analysing Rhetoric
6	Creative Writing: Crafting for Effect
7	Transactional Writing
8	Spoken Language Study
9	Poetry Anthology Study
10	Comparative Analysis: Exam Skills
11	Media Literacy & Bias
12	Advanced Essay Structure
13	Analysing a Poetry Anthology
14	Satire & Irony
15	Analysing Advertising Language
16	Writing a Formal Letter of Complaint
17	Analysing Bias in Media Texts
18	Introduction to Shakespearean Language
19	Writing a Newspaper Article
20	Introduction to Gothic Fiction
21	Analysing Propaganda Techniques
22	Writing a Film Review

HOW THIS ALIGNS WITH REAL-WORLD CURRICULA

Matches the Key Stage 3 (Year 8) National Curriculum for English; many schools begin introducing GCSE-style analysis skills at this stage, which this unit reflects — broadly equivalent to US Grade 7 Common Core ELA standards.

Grade 9

GCSE-level non-fiction and fiction analysis, a poetry anthology, spoken language study, and exam technique practice.

1	Non-Fiction Reading & Viewpoint Analysis
2	Fiction Reading: Extracts & Analysis
3	Descriptive & Narrative Writing Techniques
4	Transactional & Persuasive Writing
5	Poetry Anthology: Love and Relationships
6	Studying a Prose Text: Themes & Character
7	Studying Shakespeare: Character & Theme
8	Spoken Language & Presentation Skills
9	Comparing Unseen Poems
10	Exam Technique: Language Paper Practice
11	GCSE Creative Writing Techniques
12	Analysing Unseen Poetry
13	Spoken Language Study
14	GCSE: Analysing Prose Fiction Extracts
15	Comparative Poetry Analysis
16	Writing to Inform / Advise
17	Comparing Unseen Poems
18	Writing a Persuasive Essay
19	Spoken Language Study
20	Social and Historical Context in GCSE Texts
21	Writing an Analytical Essay
22	Analysing 19th and 20th Century Non-fiction

HOW THIS ALIGNS WITH REAL-WORLD CURRICULA

Still within Key Stage 3 (Year 9) nationally, though schools commonly start GCSE English Language and Literature content here to spread the specification over three years, as this unit does — broadly equivalent to US Grade 8 Common Core ELA standards.

Grade 10

Advanced analysis and synthesis across fiction, non-fiction and poetry, with full exam-style practice and revision strategy.

1	Advanced Non-Fiction Analysis & Synthesis
2	Advanced Fiction Analysis: Structure & Narrative Voice
3	Persuasive Speech Writing
4	Poetry Anthology: Power and Conflict
5	Studying a Prose Text: Context & Critical Interpretation
6	Shakespeare: Extract-Based Essay Writing
7	Comparing Poems Across the Anthology
8	Grammar & Accuracy for GCSE Writing
9	Full Exam-Style Practice: Language Paper
10	Final GCSE English Revision & Exam Strategy
11	GCSE Literature: Themes & Context
12	Advanced Rhetorical Analysis
13	GCSE Exam Technique & Timed Essays
14	GCSE: 19th-Century Literature Context
15	Analysing Multimodal Texts
16	Exam Technique: Analysing an Unseen Prose Extract
17	Analysing Modern Drama Extracts
18	Writing a Critical Comparative Essay
19	Exam Technique for Unseen Poetry
20	Comparing Two Non-fiction Texts
21	Creative Writing Techniques for the Exam
22	Revision and Exam Strategy for English Literature

HOW THIS ALIGNS WITH REAL-WORLD CURRICULA

Matches the Key Stage 4 (GCSE Year 1) (Year 10) — the first year of GCSE English Language and Literature study, with exam technique now a core focus — broadly equivalent to US Grade 9 (Freshman) Common Core ELA standards for that band.